MedPeers App: What Is Happening, What It Costs, What Happens Next

A plain-language brief for the app owner. No technical background needed.

1. In one paragraph

Your MedPeers app (mobile) talks to a computer on the internet that stores accounts, study partners, messages and progress. That computer is rented from a company called Vercel. It works, but it sleeps when nobody uses it and it is missing five shelves our new features need. The plan is to move the app's computer to Google (a service called Cloud Run), where it stays awake all the time. Your website, your email and your domain name stay exactly as they are.

2. Real problems your users face today

These are happening now, with the current setup:

- **The home screen locks again after unlocking (Dr Ahmar's complaint).** When the app opens, it checks three things over the internet: exam selected, questions answered, study partners. On a slow connection the answer comes back late, the app misunderstands the silence as "no progress", and shows the locked screen. The progress was never lost. This specific mistake is already fixed in the new app version waiting to be shared.
- **"Could not share" when sending questions to a partner.** The sharing button asks the server for a shelf called *mcq*. That shelf does not exist on the current server, so sharing always fails. This is one of the five missing shelves the move will create.
- **Daily ticks, study goals and "online" dots don't sync.** For the same reason, three more missing shelves (*daily*, *goals*, *presence*). Everything works on one phone but does not travel to the server or to a second device.
- **The app is slow the first time it opens.** The current computer sleeps when idle. The first user of the day waits while it wakes up. An always-awake computer removes this wait.

3. The fix, in plain words

Think of it like staff. Today the app's office uses **on-call staff**: somebody is called in every time a user taps something, then sent home. Cheap, but slow to start and they cannot keep a live conversation going. Google Cloud Run is a **full-time receptionist**: always at the desk, answers instantly, and can keep live chats and sharing running properly. Same office work, proper staffing.

What moves and what stays:

- • **Moves:** the app's computer (accounts, partners, chat, progress, sharing) → Google Cloud Run, reached at **api.medpeers.net**.
- • **Stays:** your website, your email, your domain settings, and all user data (accounts and progress move with it, so nobody has to register again).

4. What it costs, honestly

There are two kinds of money involved. Both are small:

Cost	Amount	What it really is
One-time activation	US $30 (about Rs 8,500; banks vary)	Google asks for this once to activate billing. It is **not a fee**: it becomes $30 of credit inside your Google account, used only if you ever cross the free limits. At our size it will simply sit there.
Every month	$0 at current users	Google includes millions of free uses per month, plus a $300 trial credit for new accounts. Our 5 to 10 active users consume a tiny fraction of the free share. If users ever grow into thousands per day, the cost becomes a few dollars a month, and we will tell you **before** it happens, never after.

The $30 is not refundable to your card, but it is also not spent. Think of it as a refundable-style deposit that can only be used for Google services.

5. Is my data and my users' data safe?

- • **Passwords are scrambled.** Nobody, not even us, can read a user's password. Only the user's own phone can log in with it.
- • **Google-grade locks.** The new computer runs inside Google's data centres with encrypted connections, the same standard banks use.
- • **Two keys, both with you.** Only two secret keys run the system. They stay in your accounts; we never publish or share them.
- • **Nothing is deleted during the move.** The old computer keeps running until the new one is tested and approved. If anything looks wrong on day one, we switch back in minutes.

6. What we need from you (small) vs what we handle (everything else)

- • Approve the $30 activation and link billing to the project (one screen, five minutes).
- • Later, one click in your domain settings to point **api.medpeers.net** at Google (we will tell you exactly where to click).
- • Approve the final app file before it is shared with doctors.

Everything else: building, testing all 17 features one by one, moving the data, uploading the study content, and the re-shareable app file. That is all our work.

7. What happens next, in order

1. **Step 1.** Google computer is created and the app's program is installed on it (done by us).
2. **Step 2.** All 17 features are tested one by one against it, including sharing, chat and login (done by us).
3. **Step 3. api.medpeers.net** is pointed at Google (one setting; we guide you).

4. **Step 4.** A new app file is built and shared with doctors. This version also fixes the lock-screen complaint.
5. **Step 5.** The 156 study one-liners are uploaded, and the old computer is retired only after your approval.

Prepared October 2026. Figures marked otherwise are Google’s published prices and trial terms, which Google may change; the $30 activation figure is from your own billing screen.